

HOW THE SPIRIT BRINGS THE GOSPEL HOME

Drawing, Conviction, and the Moment Truth Becomes Personal

The Spirit brings people toward Christ, makes the Gospel understood, and applies its truth to the will without performing the hearer's response or giving life before faith.



BIG IDEA

The Spirit makes the Gospel understood and presses Christ's claim upon the human will.

KEY SCRIPTURE

John 16:7-15

ALSO READ

Acts 2:36-41

MEMORY VERSE

JOHN 16:8

"And when he is come, he will reprove the world of sin, and of righteousness, and of judgment."

MAIN QUESTION

Why Does the Gospel Sometimes Become Personally Unavoidable?

45 MINUTES

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SESSION SNAPSHOT



SESSION GOALS

- Distinguish drawing, enlightenment, and conviction.
- See that the Spirit works through truth concerning Christ.
- Recognize conviction as more than guilt or emotion.
- Understand that preparatory grace is not regeneration.

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OPENING ACTIVITY: "DISTANT FACT OR PERSONAL CLAIM?"

1

STATE A DISTANT FACT (2 MIN)

Write: JESUS CHRIST DIED AND ROSE. Ask students how someone might understand and even agree with that sentence while keeping it safely distant.

2

MAKE THE CLAIM PERSONAL (2 MIN)

Add: THIS RISEN CHRIST IS MY RIGHTFUL LORD. Ask what changed when the statement began to address the hearer's own allegiance.

3

READ TWO RESPONSES (2 MIN)

Compare Acts 2:37 with Acts 7:54. In both scenes truth reaches the heart. One group asks what to do; the other hardens itself against the witness.

4

NAME THE SPIRIT'S WORK (2 MIN)

Say: the Spirit does not merely produce a feeling. He brings people toward Christ, makes the Gospel understood, and presses its claim upon the will.

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LEADER GUARDRAIL

Do not say the Spirit ignites or gives life before faith. Use drawing, enlightenment, and conviction for His preparatory work; reserve regeneration and 'gives life' for conversion. Strong feeling, sincere assent, or profound spiritual experience is not itself union with Christ.

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PREPARE

- Bible
- Board or paper
- Two colored markers
- Student handouts
- Review the Gospel summary

The Spirit makes Christ's Gospel clear, personal, and impossible to treat as neutral.

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B CORE TEACHING

1 DRAWING BRINGS THE PERSON TOWARD CHRIST John 6:44-45

God acts first, bringing people toward light and providentially toward the Gospel. Through the Gospel, drawing becomes explicitly movement toward the crucified and risen Son.

EMPHASIZE: Drawing is real divine initiative without coercion.

2 ENLIGHTENMENT MAKES THE GOSPEL UNDERSTOOD Heb. 6:4-6

The Spirit brings the Gospel into intelligible and personally significant view. A hearer may understand, assent, and experience its power without yet entrusting himself to Christ.

EMPHASIZE: Seeing that it is true is not yet giving yourself to Christ.

3 CONVICTION APPLIES THE GOSPEL TO THE WILL John 16:8-11

Through truth concerning Christ, the Spirit exposes unbelief, overturns the world's verdict, and confronts the hearer with sin, righteousness, and judgment.

EMPHASIZE: Without the Gospel there may be regret, but not spiritual conviction.

4 THE HEARER MUST RESPOND Acts 2:36-41

The Spirit does not repent or believe for the hearer. Conviction presses the necessity of response: the person may yield, evade, resist, suppress, or harden himself.

EMPHASIZE: Preparatory grace brings the will to a real decision.

3 THREE QUESTIONS - DISTINCT WORKS

DRAWING Toward whom am I being brought?

ENLIGHTENMENT What truth do I now understand?

CONVICTION What claim is this truth making upon my will?

? DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1 How is drawing different from enlightenment?

Follow-up: Direction or understanding?

2 Why must conviction include the Gospel?

Follow-up: How is it different from regret or fear?

3 What does John 16 say the Spirit exposes?

Follow-up: How is every category centered on Christ?

4 Can someone understand and assent without surrendering?

Follow-up: What does Hebrews 6 warn us about?

5 Why does conviction not remove human choice?

Follow-up: How do Acts 2 and Acts 7 show different responses?

! WEEKLY REFLECTION

Read John 16:7-15. Notice how every part of conviction concerns Christ.

- What truth about Christ do I understand?
- What response is that truth demanding from me?

+ PRIVATE CONVERSATION

If a student feels personally confronted by the Gospel, do not manufacture a public moment. Listen privately, open Scripture, and let him answer Christ honestly.

N LEADER NOTES

- Works may overlap.
- Do not make a stopwatch sequence.
- Emotion is not the test.
- No life before faith.
- Conviction permits resistance.

Enlightenment says, 'I see it.' Conviction says, 'This truth is addressing me.'